EXP 4	Design of the Book Issue Form

Aim:

To design the Book Issues form that records the issue and return of a book by a member, with the due date fixed at 14 days after the issue date.

Theory:

The Book Issues form is the transaction table of the library. Each record links one member to one book.

- **Lookup fields:** Member and Book are lookup fields that point to the Members and Books forms and show the member name and the book title.
- **Due date rule:** Due Date = Issue Date + 14 days. It is filled automatically when the form loads and whenever the Issue Date is changed.
- **Issue Status:** Issued, Returned or Overdue. It is set by workflows, not typed by the user.
- **Return Details:** Return Date and Remarks are filled when the book is returned.

Fields of the Book Issues form:

Field	Type	Rule
Issue ID	Auto Number	Starts at 1
Member	Lookup (Members)	Mandatory, shows Full Name
Book	Lookup (Books)	Mandatory, shows Book Title
Issue Date	Date	Mandatory, defaults to today
Due Date	Date	Issue Date + 14 days
Return Date	Date	Entered on return
Issue Status	Drop Down	Issued / Returned / Overdue
Remarks	Single Line	On time / late note

Procedure:

1. Create a new form named Book Issues.
2. Add two Lookup fields: Member (from Members, display Full Name) and Book (from Books, display Book Title).
3. Add Issue Date, Due Date and Return Date as Date fields, Issue Status as a drop down and Remarks as a single line field.
4. Arrange the fields into the sections Issue Details and Return Details in the Application IDE and save.
5. Open the form in the live application, choose an issue date and check that the due date moves to 14 days later.

Program (Book Issues form definition):

```
form Book_Issues
{
    displayname = "Book Issues"
    success message = "Book issue recorded successfully!"
    Section
```

```
    (
        type = section
        displayname = "Issue Details"
    )
    Issue_ID
    (
        type = autonumber
        displayname = "Issue ID"
        start index = 1
    )
    must have Member
    (
        type = picklist
        displayname = "Member"
        values = Members.ID
        displayformat = [Full_Name]
    )
    must have Book
    (
        type = picklist
        displayname = "Book"
        values = Books.ID
        displayformat = [Book_Title]
    )
    must have Issue_Date
    (
        type = date
        displayname = "Issue Date"
    )
    Due_Date
    (
        type = date
        displayname = "Due Date"
    )
    Return_Details
    (
        type = section
        displayname = "Return Details"
    )
    Return_Date
    (
        type = date
        displayname = "Return Date"
    )
    Issue_Status
    (
        type = picklist
        displayname = "Issue Status"
        values = {"Issued","Returned","Overdue"}
        initial value = "Issued"
    )
    Single_Line
    (
        type = text
        displayname = "Remarks"
    )
}
```

Output:

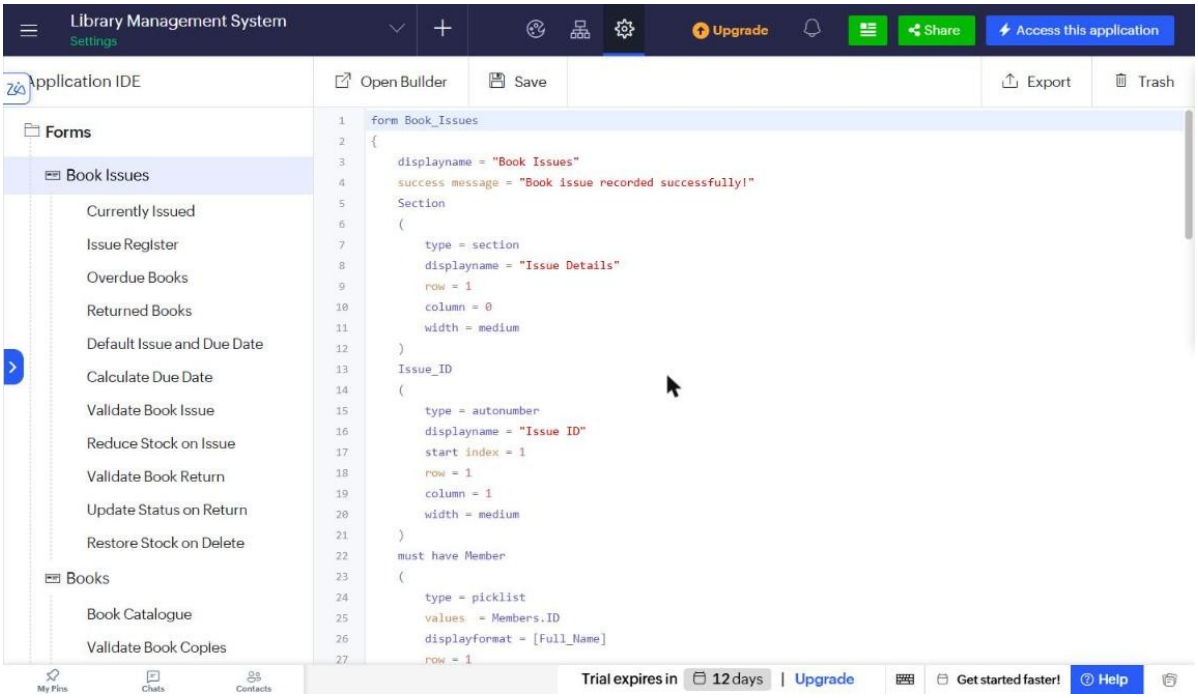


Fig. 4.1: Book Issues form definition in the Application IDE

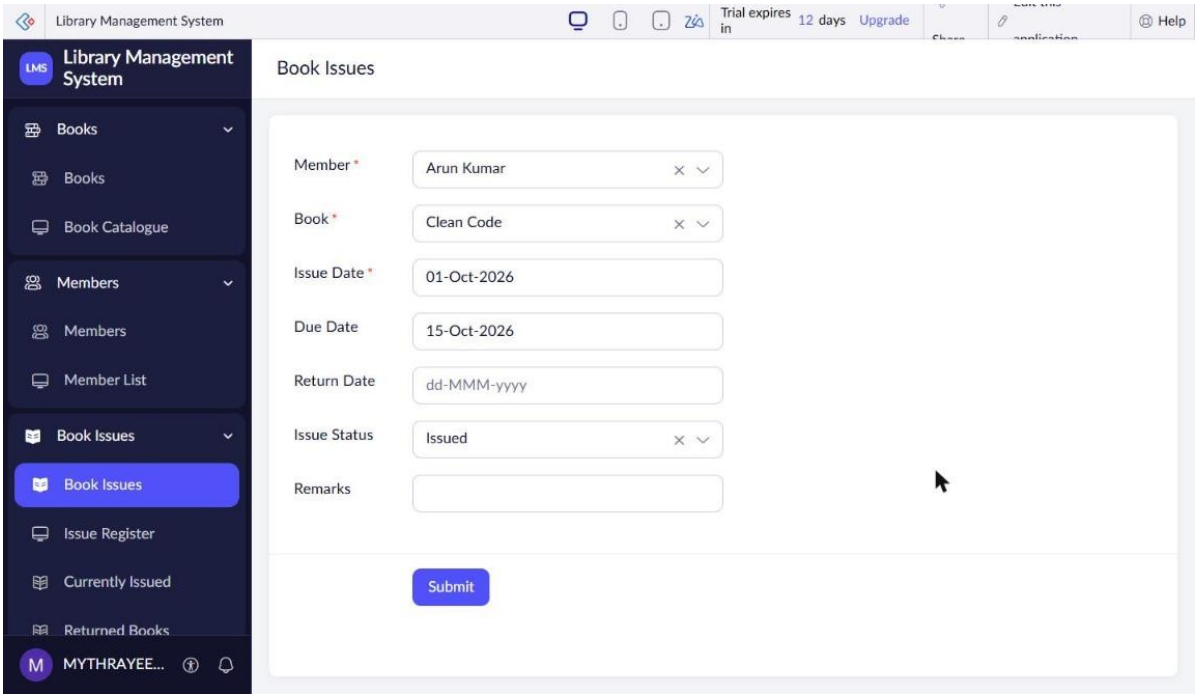


Fig. 4.2: Issue form - due date calculated as 14 days after 01-Oct-2026

Observation:

Issue Date entered	Due Date shown
01-Oct-2026	15-Oct-2026
10-Oct-2026	24-Oct-2026
15-Oct-2026	29-Oct-2026
21-Oct-2026 (default)	04-Nov-2026

Result:

The Book Issues form was created with lookups to Members and Books, and the due date is calculated automatically as 14 days after the issue date.